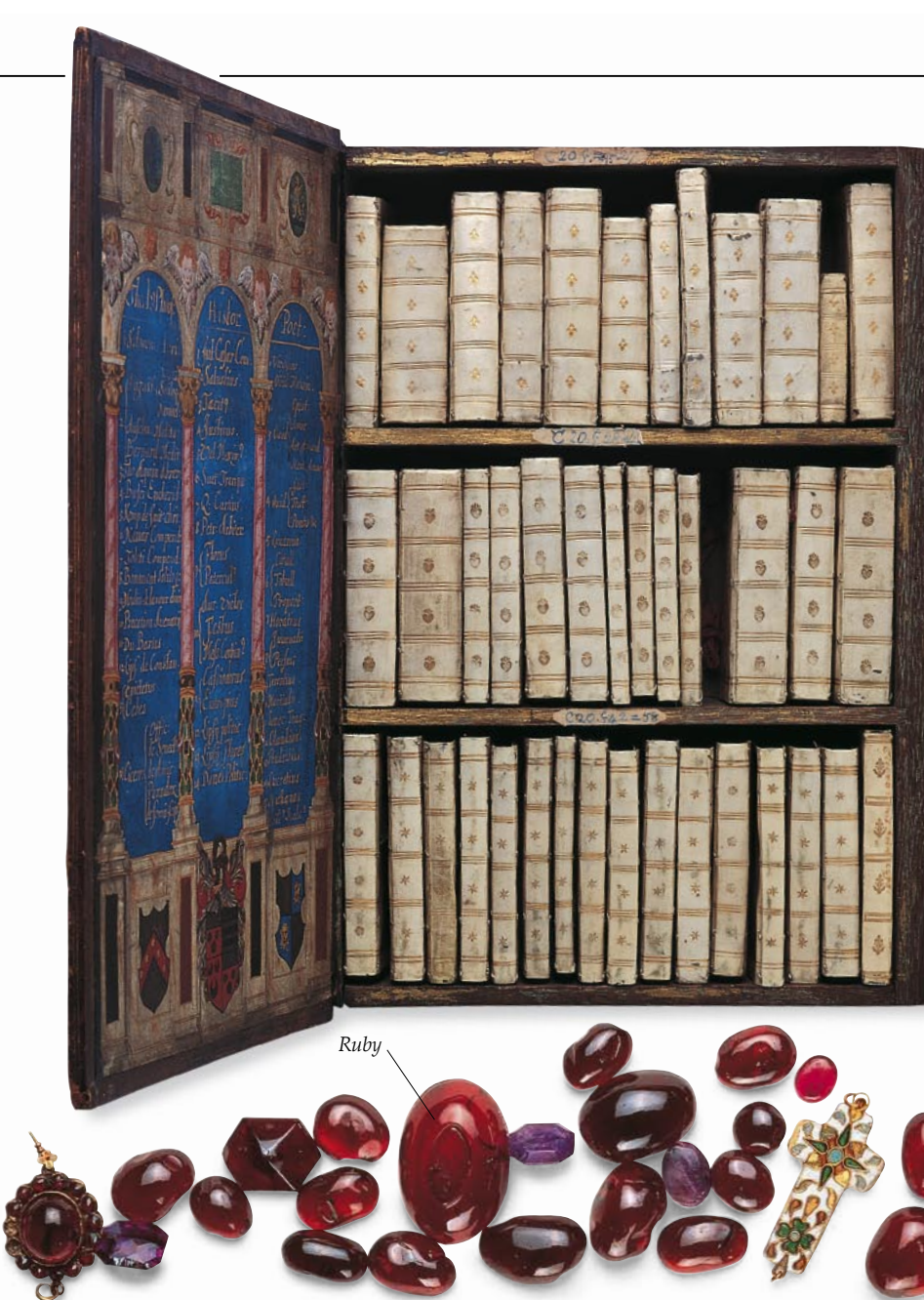




Ruby

17th-century traveling library



TRAVEL BOOKS

Elizabeth loved books and would have taken many with her when she traveled. Literature and poetry were also popular among her courtiers. Several of them, including Walter Raleigh, were talented poets. Raleigh wrote a long poem for Elizabeth called *The Ocean's Love for Cynthia*. Its title played on the queen's pet name for Raleigh, "Water." Cynthia was another name for the moon goddess.



Garnet fan-holder

Gold seal ring

Amethyst

Malachite

Garnet

DRIPPING WITH JEWELS

Both men and women at court competed to look as expensively dressed as possible. Courtiers spent vast sums of money on jewels, which they used to decorate every item of clothing, from their shoes to their hats. Some of the jewels had special meanings. For example, gems shaped like a crescent moon were worn to show devotion to the queen as the moon goddess.

Signature of Elizabeth I

Elizabeth I

Signature of Robert Devereux, Earl of Essex

PRIDE COMES BEFORE A FALL

These are the signatures of the queen and her "favorite" of the 1590s, Robert Devereux, Earl of Essex (1566–1601). Essex was a proud man, who took the queen's favor for granted. In 1601, he led a rebellion that failed. Essex was beheaded. Shakespeare refers to him in *Much Ado About Nothing* in the lines "like favorites, made proud by princes, that advance their pride against the power that bred it."



ROYAL PROCESSION

Elizabeth was sometimes carried through London by her leading courtiers in a palanquin, or covered litter. The procession gave ordinary people the chance to catch a glimpse of their queen. This 19th-century woodcut was copied from a 1601 painting by Robert Peake. The queen was 68 when it was done, but the artist portrayed her as a young goddess surrounded by worshippers.